

CASE STUDY

A government recreation team with data it couldn't use. Four days later, it could.

Municipal recreation departments track more operational data than they can use. Revenue by program, registrations by channel, facility performance, service demand, peak hours. Most of it ends up in exports and spreadsheets that take hours to analyze and are outdated before anyone acts on them.

The City of Frisco Parks and Recreation Department came to Armely with that problem. They had the data. They didn't have the tools or the skills to make it work. Armely delivered a four-day hands-on Power BI workshop built around their real data, and the team left with a working reporting environment they could maintain themselves.

Who is the City of Frisco Parks and Recreation Department?

The City of Frisco Parks and Recreation Department serves one of the fastest-growing cities in Texas. The Frisco Athletic Centre and its affiliated programs generate revenue from activities, facility rentals, and services across a large and diverse participant base of residents and nonresidents. Managing that operation requires reliable visibility into revenue, registrations, program hours, facility utilization, and service performance across multiple dimensions simultaneously.

24

Training Hours
4-day on-site workshop

8

Modules Delivered
Full Power BI lifecycle

3

Dashboard Views
Activity, Facility, Services

The Problem

The Parks and Recreation team had useful operational data. The challenge was what happened to it once it left the source system: it went into CSV exports and spreadsheets, where it sat in fragmented form that required manual work to turn into anything meaningful.

Revenue analysis required pulling and reconciling resident revenue, nonresident revenue, facility revenue, and service revenue from separate sources. There was no single view that showed all of them together. Registration reporting had the same problem: month, channel, residency, status, and service type all existed as separate data points with no consistent framework connecting them.

Leadership couldn't answer basic operational questions without a manual report build. Which services generate the most revenue? When are peak demand periods? Which programs have high withdrawal rates? How does facility utilization compare across locations? Each question required a separate effort.

And when the department did have Power BI, generic training using sample datasets had left staff without the skills to apply it to their actual reporting environment. They could navigate the tool. They couldn't use it on their own data.

Signs your team's data isn't working for your organization:

- Revenue and registration data lives across multiple disconnected exports
- Every reporting question requires a manual build from raw files
- Leadership can't compare program or facility performance without custom analysis
- Staff depend on outside help for any change to a report or dashboard
- Training used generic data that had nothing to do with your actual operations

The Approach

Armely delivered a structured four-day, 24-hour Power BI workshop on-site, built specifically around the Frisco Athletic Centre's reporting environment. Every module used real Parks and Recreation data: activity records, facility data, service and registration exports, revenue figures, and program hours.

The decision to use real data rather than sample datasets was deliberate. Generic training teaches the tool. Training on your own data teaches you how to solve your actual problems.

Eight Training Modules

The curriculum covered the full Power BI reporting lifecycle across eight structured modules.

- Power BI Fundamentals: Desktop, Service, and Mobile navigation, data connections, and building first reports.
- Data Ingestion and Cleaning: Power Query transforms, handling missing values, pivoting and unpivoting data structures.
- Data Modeling: Defining relationships between tables, understanding filter direction, and building structured data models.
- DAX Calculations: Writing measures, calculated columns, time intelligence functions, and KPI logic.
- Basic Visualizations: Charts, tables, maps, labels, titles, and tooltips.
- Advanced Reports: Slicers, filters, drill-down, drill-through, and structuring reports for decision-making.
- Power BI Service: Publishing reports, organizing workspaces, creating dashboards, and understanding refresh.
- Sharing and Security: Controlling report access, assigning workspace roles, and applying security fundamentals.

Each module combined instructor-led guidance with hands-on lab work on participant machines. Staff built skills while solving reporting problems they recognized from their daily work.

Three Dashboard Views

The workshop produced a working Power BI reporting model with three focused analytical views, each built on real Frisco Athletic Centre data.

The Activity View revealed monthly revenue, activity revenue leaders, resident versus nonresident registration trends, program hours by month, withdrawal patterns, service

utilization, and hour-by-day activity patterns. It gave leadership the operational picture that had previously required a manual pull from multiple sources.

The Facility View compared revenue across the Frisco Athletic Centre and the FAC Indoor Aquatic Facility, with consistent KPIs for revenue, registrations, and hours. Facility performance could be compared on the same terms for the first time.

The Services View ranked programs by revenue, covering Private Lessons, Level 1 through Level 7 Skill Clinic, Preschool, Adult, Teen, and Parent and Child. Service leadership and program managers could see which services drove revenue and where scheduling, staffing, or capacity decisions needed attention.

Before	After
Revenue, registrations, and hours split across CSVs and manual spreadsheets	Structured Power BI model connecting all data sources in one reporting environment
No single view of resident vs. nonresident revenue or registration trends	Activity View: revenue, registrations, hours, withdrawals, utilization by month and channel
Facility performance compared manually with no consistent framework	Facility View: revenue and KPIs compared across Frisco Athletic Centre and FAC Indoor Aquatic
Service rankings required custom reports each time	Services View: services ranked by revenue with drill-down across date, status, and type
Staff depended on outside support for any reporting changes	Internal team trained across 8 modules to maintain and extend reports independently
Training used generic data unrelated to the department's actual work	Workshop built on real Frisco Athletic Centre activity, facility, and services data

What Changed

The Parks and Recreation team finished the workshop with skills they can apply to their actual reporting environment, not a generic understanding of a tool they still can't use on their own data. They left with a working three-view dashboard built on their real operational data, and they know how to refresh it, adjust it, and extend it as their reporting needs grow.

For leadership, the dashboard delivers a single view of revenue, registrations, hours, facility performance, service rankings, and utilization patterns. Planning conversations and budget discussions now start from a trusted data view rather than a manually assembled report.

For program managers, service-level insights surface which programs drive revenue and where scheduling, staffing, or capacity changes may be warranted. For staff, the training established an internal analytics capability that doesn't depend on outside support for every report change.

"Thank you very much for another great session! This will be a big and awesome dashboard!"
-- Parks and Recreation Department staff, City of Frisco

About Armely

Armely is a Dallas-based Microsoft solutions partner. Founded in 2017, we serve over 50 clients across energy, healthcare, government, and manufacturing. Our services cover Microsoft Dynamics 365, Microsoft Fabric, Power Platform, data analytics, and AI implementation. We work as an extension of your team, from initial strategy through deployment and ongoing support.

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Your team has the data. The question is whether they can use it.

Armely offers a free Power BI readiness review for government and public sector teams. We look at your data sources, your current reporting process, and what a hands-on training engagement built around your real data would deliver.

No commitment. No sales pitch. Just an honest look at where you are.

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